THE ULTIMATE BATTLE

JULY will see a different kind of electoral battle—the one that will elect India's 18th president. The ruling BJP has nominated former Jharkhand Governor Draupadi Murmu for the post. A range of Opposition parties have grouped together to pit former Union minister Yashwant Sinha, but do not have the support of all non-NDA parties. Murmu, who has the numbers heavily tilted towards her at present, appears on track to become India's first Adivasi president, besides the first to be born in independent India.

The President's election is conducted by an electoral college consisting of all legislators—from the Lok Sabha, Rajya Sabha and state assemblies, measured by a differentially weighted value. Each MP's vote has a value of 708, whereas an MLA's vote value is determined by the population of the particular state. For instance, an MLA from Andhra Pradesh has a vote value of 159 but one from Arunachal Pradesh has a vote value of only 6. Thus, the total electoral college accounts for 1,098,903 vote values. If the present scenario of party support for each candidate stays static, barring the undecideds, the confirmed pro-Murmu vote adds up to 632,669, and the confirmed pro-Sinha vote totals 457,995. This disparity is partly because important non-NDA parties like the Biju Janata Dal and the YSR Congress have decided to back Murmu. **–ANILESH S. MAHAJAN**



ANI

DRAUPADI MURMU
632,669

RAJYA SABHA
Total seats: **234**
Vote value / seat: **708**
Total vote value: **165,672**

LOK SABHA
Total seats: **543**
Vote value / seat: **708**
Total vote value: **384,444**

ASSEMBLIES
Total seats: **4,120**
Total vote value: **543,380**



SHEKHAR GHOSH

YASHWANT SINHA
457,995

RAJYA SABHA
94,164
(MPs: BJP 92, NDA allies 18, Other parties 23)

LOK SABHA
271,164
(MPs: BJP 303, NDA allies 33, Other parties 47)

ASSEMBLIES
267,341

RAJYA SABHA
71,508
(MPs: Congress 31, UPA allies 17, Other parties 53)

LOK SABHA
110,448
(MPs: Congress 53, UPA allies 56, Other parties 47)

ASSEMBLIES
276,039

Undecided parties in Lok Sabha: **3,540**

NB: These numbers are based on the currently confirmed parties supporting both sides. Any change in their decisions can alter the equation.

Graphic by **TANMOY CHAKRABORTY**

